

Not just any Glance: India's growing smartphone habit

Piyush Shah

Co-founder of InMobi Group and
COO & President of Glance



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In an age where the digital content creation and consumption landscape is continually evolving, Glance, an AI-powered platform with a difference, is carving a niche in the world of content consumption that aims to redefine and disrupt how we interact with our most intimate of modern gadgets: the smartphone. Dismissed by some as 'bloatware' or an unnecessary fad, Glance is a serious disruptor in the tech arena, according to Piyush Shah, Co-founder of InMobi Group and COO & President of Glance.

"We wanted to build something incredibly convenient for individuals always on the go," Shah says, explaining the inception of Glance back in 2019. It's an ambition that has led to the creation of a platform offering everything from instant games to live streaming, all on the lock screen of Android smartphones. This is not just a feature but a fundamental shift in how users engage with their devices, according to Shah.

Even the most ardent critics of Glance can't argue against its genius and utter simplicity of use. By leveraging the lock screen, a space typically underutilised beyond wanton app notifications, Glance has turned it into a dynamic interface, pulsating with content tailored to individual tastes and preferences. Shah emphasises that it's all about reimagining possibilities, "We were very clear that we will reimagine the way consumers engage with their phones, and we picked up lock screen as the surface to provide that experience."

The use of AI and machine learning is the cornerstone of this reimagined engagement. Glance's algorithms delve deep into understanding user behaviour, curating content that resonates on a personal level. Shah proudly states, "Our technology enables both speed and scale of content delivery. The delivery of fresh content happens in a mere 200 milliseconds, and our personalised content reaches over 450 million devices every day."

But what does this mean for the average user? For starters, an average

Glance user spends about 25 minutes daily on their lock screen. Shah notes, "Our platform has witnessed a 1.2x growth in active users in India and 1.3x growth in active users globally in the last year." With several hundred million 'Glances' daily, Shah's startup seems to have unlocked the Android smartphone's lock screen as a format for sticky, unputdownable, and immersive interactions. These numbers don't just speak to the platform's popularity, they underscore a fundamental shift in consumer behaviour, according to Shah.

Despite its success, Glance faces a delicate balancing act of continuing to provide constant value without overwhelming its users. As a facilitator of the platform, Shah understands this conundrum all too well. "Our focus is to help users stay up to date, learn or discover something new," he says, highlighting the platform's emphasis on curating content that is both engaging and valuable. Aware of what he describes as a massive responsibility of curating personalised content for millions of smartphone users across India and the world, Shah